The Major Terpenes

The loud ones — the terpenes that set a flower's primary character. Color stripe shows the profile each one drives.

PRIMARY DRIVERS · 9

Myrcene
Earthy / Dank

Earthy, musky, ripe mango, clove

Most abundant cannabis terpene; sets a heavy grounding base and amplifies overall aromatic weight.

FOUND WITH · β-Caryophyllene · Limonene · α-Pinene

D-Limonene
Citrus / Bright

Citrus, lemon, orange peel

Defines bright citrus character; with caryophyllene and myrcene it turns the corner into gas.

FOUND WITH · β-Caryophyllene · Myrcene · Terpinolene

β-Caryophyllene
Spicy / Warm

Black pepper, clove, warm wood

The pepper backbone; aromatically loud, so even moderate levels drive a clear spice/gas lead.

FOUND WITH · Humulene · Limonene · Myrcene

Linalool
Floral / Soft

Lavender, floral, sweet spice

Potent at low levels; a little linalool softens and perfumes the whole profile.

FOUND WITH · β-Caryophyllene · Limonene · Myrcene

α-Pinene
Piney / Fresh

Pine needle, fresh, sharp

Crisp pine sharpness; cuts through heavier terpenes and reads as fresh and bright.

FOUND WITH · β-Pinene · Myrcene · Terpinolene

β-Pinene
Piney / Fresh

Pine, dill, woody-herbal

Pairs with α-pinene for forest character with a slightly more herbal, resinous edge.

FOUND WITH · α-Pinene · Myrcene

Terpinolene
Fruity / Sweet

Fruity, floral, piney, fresh

Complex and volatile; a terpinolene lead signals bright, fruity-fresh haze character.

FOUND WITH · Myrcene · β-Ocimene · α-Pinene

α-Humulene
Herbal / Woody

Hops, woody, dry earth

Travels with caryophyllene; adds a dry, hoppy woodiness and depth to gassy profiles.

FOUND WITH · β-Caryophyllene · Myrcene

β-Ocimene
Tropical / Tangy

Sweet, herbal, tropical

Sweet tropical lift; pushes a profile toward exotic, fruity-floral territory.

FOUND WITH · Terpinolene · Limonene · Myrcene

KEY IMPACT TERPENES · 7

α-Bisabolol
Floral / Soft

Chamomile, soft floral, sweet

Smooth, delicate floral; a marker of refined, premium-feeling profiles.

FOUND WITH · Linalool · β-Caryophyllene

Valencene
Citrus / Bright

Sweet orange, grapefruit

Juicy citrus top-note; lifts and rounds out limonene-forward profiles.

FOUND WITH · Limonene · Myrcene

trans-Nerolidol
Floral / Soft

Apple, rose, woody bark

Soft woody-floral bridge; adds depth and a fresh-bark finish.

FOUND WITH · Linalool · β-Caryophyllene · Bisabolol

Guaiol
Herbal / Woody

Pine, rose-wood, cooling

Rare woody-cooling note; signals a distinctive, structured profile.

FOUND WITH · α-Humulene · α-Pinene

α-Terpineol
Floral / Soft

Lilac, pine, clove

Soft lilac-pine; smooths transitions between floral and resinous notes.

FOUND WITH · α-Pinene · Linalool

Caryophyllene Oxide
Spicy / Warm

Dry pepper, oxidized wood

Oxidation marker of caryophyllene; dry, savory-spice edge.

FOUND WITH · β-Caryophyllene · α-Humulene

p-Cymene
Gas / Fuel

Pungent, solvent, citrus-spice

A genuine gas marker, usually present in small amounts — a confirming note, not the main driver.

FOUND WITH · Limonene · γ-Terpinene · β-Caryophyllene